Ashen Spiral 0.20 — Bug & Dead-Content Fix Decisions

Decided by Josue on 2026-10-13 (rapid-fire review of Claude's Section 4 table + §3.5 items). Each finding below was verified against the 0.19.0 source before the decision was made.

1. Treasure Sense — REMOVE + refund

Talent text promises a gold minimap halo for elites; no halo implementation exists anywhere in Source/. **Do:** Remove the talent, refund 1 Skill Point to any profile that bought it (Talent 9, ASData.cpp). **Do not** implement Claude's Prospector's Eye rework — explicitly rejected.

2. Vault Sense — already handled, no action

ID 55 stays reserved/retired. Already correct in 0.19.

3. Ashen Kindling + Cinder Wake — apply the REAL Burn status

Both are relics that work as plain damage but promise "ignite/burn":

- Ashen Kindling (Relic 0): currently +3 flat well pulse damage (ASSpell.cpp:174). Add `ApplyElement(Burn)` at ~60% power alongside the damage.
- Cinder Wake (Relic 10): currently spawns a damaging dash field (ASCharacter.cpp:330, field Kind 1). Apply the Burn status to enemies hit by the trail. This makes the words true and creates synergy with Kindling Touch / burn scaling. It is a small buff — intended.

4. Shattered Ring — REWORD to "poison arrows"

Relic says "fire six ash shards" but the code fires weapon-type-2 projectiles: SM_Arrow mesh + poison-green coloring (ASSpell.cpp:193, `AASProjectile::Fire(...,Hero,2,16)`; WeaponElement(2)=Poison). **Do:** Change text to match behavior ("collapsed wells fire six poison arrows"). Do not change the visuals.

5. Second Echo — FIX to single area scaling (verified bug)

`AASWell::Collapse()` passes the already-area-scaled radius R into the echo field, whose tick calls `Hero->Area()` — which applies `AreaScale()` a second time (ASCharacter.cpp:351). The main blast on the line above correctly divides by AreaScale first. **Do:** Spawn the echo field with `R / Hero-`

`>AreaScale()` (ASSpell.cpp, Relic(6) branch). Note: the echo's visual ring uses the unscaled radius — keep visual and damage consistent.

6. Rune Nova — make it work with ANY ability (design change, not gating)

Rune Nova ("evolve Rune Lance into a 300cm area blast") can be drafted with any ability selected — the offer `Context` struct doesn't even carry the selected ability, and its effect only fires in the Rune Lance path (ASAbilities.cpp:24). **Do:** Generalize the effect so it applies to whichever ability is selected (the selected ability's impact becomes an area blast). Do NOT gate the offer on Rune Lance — explicitly rejected.

7. Ash Mantle + Linked Landing — fix the shield clamp (verified bug)

Both use `Shield = Min(60, Shield + gain)` (ASCharacter.cpp:317, ASSpell.cpp:182). If shield is already above 60, the "cap" *reduces* it. **Do:** Use max-guard logic — never let the grant lower current shield: `Shield = Max(Shield, Min(60, Shield + gain))`. Fix both sites.

8. Guardian Link — ADD the 720cm proximity check

Currently any hero with the talent gains a shield when anyone takes a heavy hit, at any distance, even solo (ASCharacter.cpp:367). The name promises a co-op link. **Do:** Require the hit-taker and the talent holder to be within 720cm. Do not rename — explicitly rejected.

9. Twin style — fix the TEXT (no-brainer)

"Twin: Two smaller wells per cast" is wrong. Code plants the second well at exactly 0.72 scale (ASCharacter.cpp:316). **Do:** "Main well at full size; second well at 72% size." Applies to the Twin style (Styles[10] index 6).

10. Razor Dash — ADD phase-through on dash

Trait says "dash through enemies" but pawn capsules block each other, so the dash collides instead of passing through. The damage trace itself works (ASCharacterUpgrades.cpp:143). **Do:** While the dash is active (`bDashTraceActive`), ignore enemy pawn collision so the dash passes through bodies. This changes dash feel in crowds — intended.

11. Crystal Shard + Vine Fiber — REMOVE the dead currencies (reversal noted)

Earlier call was "add a sink"; final decision is **removal**. Materials[2] (Crystal Shard) and Materials[3] (Vine Fiber) have zero spend sites anywhere — only Scrap, Bone Dust, and Spiral Cores are spent (Ember Refinement, Memory Point). **Do:** Remove both currencies. Migrate existing player balances into Scrap. Update drop tables, hub UI, save profiles, and the editable catalog. This supersedes Claude §5.1's crystal/vine proposals (Crystal Lens, Vine Cache) — do not implement those.

12. Side-room traps — FIX the selection loop (verified bug)

The side-room loop `for (I=3; I<cells; I+=6)` spawns kind `I%2 ? 4 : 5` (ASGameMode.cpp ~line 202). I is always odd, so it's always flame (kind 4) — the rotating-blade branch (kind 5) can never spawn. The vault loop below it alternates correctly. **Do:** Alternate on a dedicated counter instead of the cell index.

13. XP / levels / achievements — ADD small non-power rewards

All 36 achievement milestones and the level track are cosmetic. **Do:** Grant small non-power rewards at milestones: Relic Embers, Tablets, cosmetics, titles. Never raw power.

Explicitly deferred / not decided here

- Claude §3 balance numbers (enemy ward scaling, boss HP, reload/attack-speed, abilities, weapons, Honed Edge) — NOT approved; telemetry first (Prompt 1 ordering stands).
- New unlocks (§5), boss redesigns, Heat ladder — not in scope for this pass.
- Claude's 10 direction questions (§7) — still open for Josue + partner to answer separately.